

setting from among three meagre options—300 dpi, Custom and EconoMode. You can also print formats such as Envelope and choose different paper sizes.

The cartridge slides out along with the cover when you open it. The LaserJet 1000 sports a parallel interface but

Price: Rs 17,500
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SmartDraw 6.0 Standard Edition

Easy draw

Professional flowcharts, network diagrams, floor plans and more...SmartDraw 6.0 allows for easy creation of all the above. The program comes with an Explorer type template viewer, which proves quite handy while selecting and using the various templates provided. Another plus point of this application is its ability to download templates as and when required, giving you a lot of flexibility in case of a space crunch. It supports various file formats including PDF, JPEG, TIFF, HTML, WMF and GIF, to name a few.

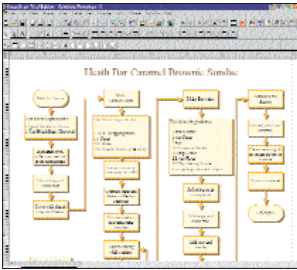
Another noteworthy feature is its ability to integrate Office suite files like Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint. For mathematical calculations, you can also incorporate equations and special symbols not generally supported by the keyboard. It also allows you to create timeline calendars in the form of Gantt charts, yearly timelines or a monthly calendar. With around 11 categories of templates and with each category having around five to seven different samples, this software has one of the most elaborative lists.

Price: Rs 3,312 Standard, Rs 6,192 Professional and Rs 9,504 Professional Plus (approx prices). There's also a 30-day shareware version.
Web site: www.smartdraw.com

comes bundled with a parallel to USB converter so that the printer can also be used on a USB port.

SPECIFICATIONS
10 pages per minute, parallel/USB 1.1 interface, 600 dpi resolution, HP PCL 5e print language

HP LaserJet 1000 series B				
Performance	▶	▶	▶	▶
Build Quality	▶	▶	▶	▶
Value for Money	▶	▶	▶	▶
Features	▶	▶	▶	▶
OVERALL	▶	▶	▶	▶



However, every time you start the program for a new design, the application takes you to the template selection screen, which is rather cumbersome.

This software is available in three different versions: the Standard version with 1000 symbols; the Professional version with 1000 standard symbols plus features supporting MS applications as well as file import and export facility; and the Professional Plus with all the professional features and a collection of 11 symbol categories including Business, Networks, Engineering and Maps.

SPECIFICATIONS
Works with Windows 95/98/Me/2000 and XP, needs a minimum of 30 MB free disk space

SmartDraw 6.0 B+				
Performance	▶	▶	▶	▶
Ease of use	▶	▶	▶	▶
Value for Money	▶	▶	▶	▶
Features	▶	▶	▶	▶
OVERALL	▶	▶	▶	▶

Sony Multiscan E230

For the professional



The E230 is a 17-inch true flat screen monitor with a 0.25 mm aperture grille pitch. It has a neat joystick-style OSD interface for setting the various parameters. The monitor did very well in the geometry test, showing perfectly straight lines. This can be attributed to the aperture grille technology used in the monitor. It produced colours precisely and its clarity was perfect. However, it did show some signs of weakness in the streaking and ghosting tests, with a little ghosting visible near the white and

Price: Rs 23,000
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yellow colour bands. There was also a slight white as well as black level shift and the edges appeared blurred. In the horizontal bar resolution test the gap between two bars was not visible, which made a distinct moiré pattern. The monitor fared well in the dark screen test with hardly any reflections visible in the background.

The E230 comes bundled with just a quick start manual and a power cord. This monitor would be suitable for the professional who works with high-end CAD/CAM, imaging and 3D authoring applications. Its price, however, is a bit steep.

SPECIFICATIONS
Resolution of 1600x1200 at 68 Hz, 0.25 mm stripe pitch, 30-85 KHz horizontal frequency, 40-170 Hz vertical frequency

Sony Multiscan E230 B				
Performance	▶	▶	▶	▶
Build Quality	▶	▶	▶	▶
Value for Money	▶	▶	▶	▶
Features	▶	▶	▶	▶
OVERALL	▶	▶	▶	▶

Nikon COOLPIX 775

Just right for the amateur photographer

This camera sports a cool 2.14-Megapixel capable CCD that helps you take photographs at a maximum resolution of 1600x1200 pixels. It offers three resolutions: 1600x1200, 1024x768 and 640x480. It can also capture short videos (15 seconds maximum) at a rather paltry 15 frames per second. You can select from seven white balance modes depending on the lighting conditions. It offers three capture modes: single, continuous, and multi-shot (16 frames at 400x300 pixel resolution). It's compactly



designed and fits into the palm snugly. All the buttons are well within reach of the thumb and index finger. Transferring images to the PC is very easy,